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The State of Your Databricks & Snowflake Bill

October 2026:

(5 CHANGES LANDING ON YOUR BILL THIS AUTUMN THAT YOUR PLATFORM TEAM SHOULD KNOW ABOUT)

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This Month: Five Quiet Changes To Your Bill

None of these is a price rise. That's why they're easy to miss.

A new default, a closing deadline, a limit that isn't quite a limit. Four change your Databricks and Snowflake bills, or how clearly you can see them. One is an ETL deadline that belongs in the same budget.

For each change: what it means for your bill, what changed, and one thing to do this week.

Here are the 5 changes for October 2026:

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Change #1: A 100-Credit Snowflake Limit Can Bill 130

For your Snowflake bill: a weekly credit limit is a speed bump, not a wall. Limits are per user and never pooled, so ten users at 100 credits is 1,000 credits of exposure.

What changed: per-user weekly credit limits went GA on 16 September. Enforcement isn't instant. Snowflake's own example shows a 100-credit limit ending at 130.

Start here: set limits below your real ceiling, and keep an account-level budget alert behind them.

Source: docs.snowflake.com, per-user credit quotas and new features (GA 16 Sep 2026)

Change #2: Snowflake Notebook Jobs Move To A Different Compute Line

For your Snowflake bill: the replacement notebooks run on Container Runtime, on a compute pool. Same work, a different line on the bill.

What changed: legacy Notebooks stop in November 2026. They can't be run or edited, and every scheduled Task or pipeline that calls **EXECUTE NOTEBOOK** stops.

Start here: list every Task that calls EXECUTE NOTEBOOK this week, and price the compute pool before you move them.

Source: docs.snowflake.com, behaviour change: disable legacy notebooks; Snowsight notebooks docs

Change #3: Delete A Databricks Pipeline, Keep Paying For Its Tables

For your storage bill: retire a pipeline and its tables stay in storage, and can keep billing, with nobody left who owns them.

What changed: since 25 September, deleting a Unity Catalog pipeline keeps its tables by default. They're only removed with **cascade=true**.

Start here: when you retire a pipeline, decide what happens to its tables in the same change.

Source: docs.databricks.com, release notes, September 2026

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Change #4: See Which Queries Drive Your Databricks SQL Spend

For your Databricks bill: tag queries by team or cost centre and you can see which queries, teams and dashboards drive a warehouse's spend, so you know what to tune first.

What changed: the query history system table went GA on 21 September. Query tags for SQL warehouses followed on 30 September, and they appear in that table.

Start here: agree a small tag set (team, cost_centre) and apply it to your busiest dashboards first.

Source: docs.databricks.com, release notes, September 2026 (system.query.history GA; query tags GA)

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Change #5: Talend 7.3 Extended Support Sales End In December

For your budget: upgrading and moving both cost time and money. The cheaper option is the one you plan for now, not in January.

What changed: Qlik's lifecycle page (updated 8 October) says extended support for Talend 7.3 can be bought only through December 2026. Talend 8 is the only supported on-prem version.

Start here: count your 7.3 jobs and pick upgrade or move before your 2027 budget closes.

Source: help.qlik.com, Talend product end-of-life planning (updated 8 Oct 2026)

The Pattern: Cost Changes Arrive As Defaults And Deadlines

Not one of these five shows up as a price rise. Each shows up later, as a bill nobody can fully explain.

Most cost optimisation isn't a big project. It's noticing changes like these early, and having the evidence to act on them.

Want a second pair of eyes? We'll look at your own Databricks or Snowflake bill with you. Book a demo at **bighammer.ai/book-demo**